

Special Meeting - Medford School Committee Notes
May 7, 2020 - 4 PM, Via Zoom

Pursuant to Governor Baker's March 12, 2020 Order Suspending Certain Provisions of the Open Meeting Law, G.L. c. 30A, §18, and the Governor's March 15, 2020 Order imposing strict limitations on the number of people that may gather in one place, this meeting of the Medford School Committee will be conducted via remote participation to the greatest extent possible. Specific information and the general guidelines for remote participation by members of the public and/or parties with a right and/or requirement to attend this meeting can be found on the City of Medford website, at www.medfordma.org. For this meeting, members of the public who wish to listen or watch the meeting may do so by accessing the meeting link contained herein. No in-person attendance of members of the public will be permitted, but every effort will be made to ensure that the public can adequately access the proceedings in real time, via technological means. In the event that we are unable to do so, despite best efforts, we will post on the City of Medford or Medford Community Media websites an audio or video recording, transcript, or other comprehensive record of proceedings as soon as possible after the meeting.

The meeting can be viewed through Medford Community Media on Comcast Channel 22 and Verizon Channel 43 at 4:00 p.m.

Since the meeting will be held remotely, participants can log or call in by using the following link or call-in number:

- (1) [Medford School Committee Meeting on Zoom](#)
- (2) Telephone Information (choose any one of the following and then follow the prompts)
 - (a) 1-929-205-6099
 - (b) 1-312-626-6799
 - (c) 1-301-715-8592
 - (d) 1-346-248-7799
 - (e) 1-669-900-6833
 - (f) 1-253-215-8782
 - (i) Enter this meeting ID when prompted: 999 5322 0338

Additionally, questions or comments can be submitted during the meeting by emailing medfordsc@medford.k12.ma.us. Those submitting must include the following information:

- 1) Your first and last name
- 2) Your Medford street address

3) Your question or comment

While it is possible to submit questions via the Zoom software, we are strongly recommending that you use the email above while we gain familiarity with hosting our meetings online.

Meeting called to order - 4:02 PM

Attendance - Roll Call Vote - 7-0

Mayor: Resolution offered by Ms. Van der Kloot, that the Medford School Committee offers its sincere thanks to Assistant Superintendent Dr. Cushing, Headmaster D'Alleva, Assistant Principal Blauch, Principal Chad Fallon, Principal Lisa Kingsley, Athletic Director Bob Maloney and the Mustang Coaching Staff for their Midnight posting of lawn signs, **(A Medford High School Senior Lives Here)** to celebrate the members of the Class of 2020. This simple gesture brought such surprise and joy to both the students and their families.

Member Van der Kloot - A quick thank you to all involved who made our seniors feel great. I have received so many nice comments and want to thank all those involved in the midnight ride.

Member McLaughlin - I agree and also the folks putting together the Senior Adoption Program that is making our seniors feel so special.

Member Kretz - I agree as well. I have seen them on my walk. A parent said to me, what a surprise! I hope to join the Senior Adoption Program too

Mayor - Yes, I agree. I thank everyone involved. I will adopt students as well, I missed the ones I already knew! That's how fast the students are being adopted. It will be a great program as well.

Motion to go into Executive Session Negotiations and Legal Matters, by Member Van der Kloot, seconded by Member McLaughlin, motion passes. We will enter the executive session.

1. To discuss collective bargaining:

- Union Contracts
 - Medford Teachers Association
 - MOA including DLP Addendum
 - Kids Corner
 - Cafeteria
- Non-Union Contracts

Vice Chairperson Ruseau resumes meeting at 5:45 PM

This meeting link is not the one that is published, as the Governor's order states we do our best possible means to provide access. This meeting will be recorded. The City Council is meeting live now. Do we have to call the roll?

Member Van der Kloot - No

Mayor had another meeting. We have met in executive session and we have 2 motions to report out?

Member Van der Kloot - yes, I believe so

Vice Chairperson Ruseau - The first motion that was offered by Member Mustone.

Member Mustone - This motion was offered by myself, Vice Chairperson Ruseau, and Member Graham - to reconsider our vote regarding Kids Corner to furlough 5/4/2020 and we will continue to pay the Kids Corner staff until the end of the school year, 2019-2020. It is our opinion that their role is similar to others currently employed by the Medford Public Schools within the MEEP program and at this time we need not allow the nature of our funding mechanisms, such as revolving accounts, to supersede the importance of this program and the employees role and value during this unprecedented time. The Kids Corner Director will submit a DLP and expectations and protocols and will deliver that plan no later than May 15th. We are deeply disappointed the communications were not made clear. The Superintendent will notify Kids Corner of our decision no later than May 11th. Their pay will be uninterrupted. In these very uncertain times, we want you all to know that we value your service. We expect clear and direct communication, through the school year, the summer and new school year. There may be changes, but we will keep you informed. It is our job to make sound short range decisions for a long range outlook. We will have to make a number of difficult decisions in the days ahead. We further urge that all communications be outlined within 24 hours of decisions made by the Medford School Committee.

This motion is offered by Mea Mustone, Paul Ruseau, and Jenny Graham

We make a motion to reconsider our decision to furlough the Kids Corner teachers effective 5/4/2020. We will continue to pay the Kids Corner staff through the end of the 2019/2020 school year. It is our opinion that their role is similar to others currently employed by Medford Public Schools within the MEEP program, and at this time we need not allow the nature of our funding mechanisms for these two programs supersede the employees' role and value. We

remain deeply concerned about the viability of this and other programs managed by tuition-based revolving accounts in light of the COVID-19 pandemic.

Further, the director of the Kids Corner program will provide a documented distance learning plan covering all students that outlines expectations moving forward, and identifies where distance learning is not possible. The plan will establish protocols and expectations consistent with other similar programs in the community. This plan will be delivered to the School Committee no later than 5/15/2020.

Further, we are deeply disappointed in the communication to our valued Kids Corner team, and to our other hourly workers who are critical to our operations, but have been furloughed by us. The Superintendent or her designee will reach out to Kids Corner employees no later than 5/11/2020 to inform them that the decision to furlough was reconsidered and that their pay will continue uninterrupted. That communication will include the following statement from the School Committee:

"In these very uncertain times, we as the School Committee take our role very seriously. We as a district value the service you provide to our staff and students. You have our commitment that we will continue to advocate for clear and direct communication to you about your employment through the end of this school year, through the summer, and as we prepare for the start of the next school year. There may be changes ahead, and we will be clear about how they impact you and engage you as proactively as possible.

We know that the public has entrusted us to steer our schools to improved outcomes. Right now, that means that we are faced with difficult decisions regarding our school district's financial obligations. It is our job to make sound short-range decisions to ultimately make our long-range outlook as good as it can be. We will be faced with many more decisions about the future of our schools if our city's funding is not supplemented beyond what we know about today. We as a district value the service you provide. You have our commitment that we will weigh and consider the value you and your co-workers bring to our staff and students, and that we will do that for all our employees who may be impacted by our uncertain future."

Further, the communication outlined above will be delivered to any and all staff impacted by furlough decisions made by this Committee within 24 hours of any decision. For those impacted groups where more than 24 hours has passed, this communication will be delivered no later than 5/11/2020.

Motion to approve by Member Graham, seconded by Member Mustone -Roll Call vote
6-affirmative 1 absent - motion passes

Vice Chairperson Ruseau - thank you to all. It was a lot of work. The motion reversed our decision from last week's meeting regarding Kids Corner.

Member McLaughlin - Please send a copy of the motion to all school committee members. We appreciate that the Superintendent met with the Kids Corner teachers yesterday.

Ms. Caldwell - Mea, please forward a copy of the motion to the Superintendent as well.

Vice Chairperson Ruseau - I would like to thank the teachers union and the Supt office for their continuing work on the MOA these past few weeks.

Member Van der Kloot - after a lengthy discussion - Motion made by Member McLaughlin to table the debate and submit questions to the Superintendent to bring back to the negotiations.

We will discuss those again next Thursday, May 14th, seconded by Member Graham

Roll Call -

6- affirmative

1 - absent

Motion passes

Vice Chair Ruseau - Meeting on May 14th - TBA - We just didn't have enough time to properly discuss this issue. Anything else?

Motion to adjourn by Member McLaughlin, seconded by Member Kreatz -

Roll Call Vote

6- affirmative

1 - absent

Motion passes -

Meeting adjourned 8:40 PM